



Tweaking Agency

Google Ads That Actually Work

Joey Stiver — PR media target research

Client: **Joey Stiver**

Date: **2026-06-23**

29 targets · PR review applied · 10 Avoid · 8 Active

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Executive summary

Joey Stiver (joeystiver.com) bootstrapped a mid-nine-figure healthcare portfolio (Amble, MinuteMD, Vaxxen Labs, MedLab) from an **\$8,000 credit card** after a federal conviction — with no venture capital and a 12-year pristine telehealth compliance record. He leads the Joey Stiver Foundation and the **St. Dismas Accelerator**, piloting AI-driven entrepreneurship training for formerly incarcerated adults in Ohio and Puerto Rico.

List status (PR manager review 2026-06-23)

STATUS	COUNT
Total researched	29
Avoid	10
Low	2
Pitched Previously	9
Active	8

Top 5 pitch-first contacts

1. **Tom Huddleston Jr.** (CNBC Make It) — Suitable; bootstrap comeback profiles.
2. **Will Davis** (WYSO) — St. Dismas Ohio pilot; Community Voices audio.
3. **Stephen Hays** (Stigma Podcast) — Good match; second-chance healthcare founder.
4. **Alison Coleman** (Forbes) — Bootstrapping beat; strongest Tier-1 follow-up.
5. **Sharon Minelli Pérez** (El Nuevo Día) — PR St. Dismas / startup ecosystem.

PR Status key: Active = net-new · Pitched Previously = follow-up · Low = deprioritize · Avoid = do not contact

Full contact list

PUBLICATION	JOURNALIST	PRIORITY	PR STATUS	NOTES
CNBC Make It	Ashton Jackson <i>Make It Success Reporter</i>	High	Pitched Previously	Good match — follow-up lane
CNBC Make It	Tom Huddleston Jr. <i>Senior Entrepreneurs Reporter</i>	Top 5	Active	Suitable — net-new Top 5
Entrepreneur	Amanda Breen <i>Senior Features Writer</i>	High	Pitched Previously	Good match — follow-up lane
Entrepreneur UK	Patricia Cullen <i>Features Writer</i>	Medium	Pitched Previously	Good match — follow-up lane
Fast Company	Ainsley Harris <i>Senior Writer</i>	Low	Pitched Previously	Good match — follow-up lane; departing for Hark
Forbes	Alison Coleman <i>Senior Contributor</i>	Top 5	Pitched Previously	Good match — Top 5 follow-up; bootstrapping beat
Fortune	Indrani Sen <i>Senior Editor Features</i>	Low	Avoid	Mainly covers archives — not suitable for startup pitch
Fortune	Matthew Heimer <i>Executive Editor Features</i>	Low	Avoid	Left Fortune
Grit Daily	Spencer Hulse <i>Editorial Director</i>	Medium	Low	Paid to play — sponsored strategy only; not earned media
Inc.	Graham Winfrey <i>Deputy Digital Editor</i>	High	Pitched Previously	Pitched previously — follow-up; demoted from Top 5 for net-new focus
Inc.	Nick Hawkins <i>Assistant Web Producer</i>	High	Pitched Previously	Pitched previously — follow-up lane
Inc.	Tim Crino <i>Senior Editor</i>	High	Pitched Previously	Pitched previously — follow-up lane

PUBLICATION	JOURNALIST	PRIORITY	PR STATUS	NOTES
Entrepreneur	Leo Zevin <i>Contributing Writer</i>	Low	Pitched Previously	Pitched previously — athlete entrepreneur beat
Inc.	Christine Lagorio-Chafkin <i>Editor-at-Large</i>	High	Avoid	No longer with Inc.
STAT	Katie Palmer <i>Health Tech Correspondent</i>	Avoid	Avoid	Not suitable — writes critically of GLP-1 space businesses and CEOs
Fierce Healthcare	Heather Landi <i>Executive Editor</i>	Avoid	Avoid	Not suitable — covers big pharma; do not tread on that beat
Practical Founders Podcast	Greg Head <i>Host</i>	Avoid	Avoid	Software-founder-only podcast — Joey is not a software founder
The Bootstrap	Scotty Allen <i>Host</i>	High	Active	Also hello@theproductbus.com
The Human Challenge	Vanessa Ferlaino <i>Host</i>	High	Avoid	Beat mismatch — refugees DEI female voices; not felony/reentry entrepreneurship
Stigma Podcast	Stephen Hays <i>Host</i>	High	Active	Good match — second-chance healthcare founder
From That Comes This	Rebecca Foster <i>Host</i>	Medium	Low	Good fit but audience too small — Joey time constraint
WYSO	Will Davis <i>Director Community Voices</i>	Top 5	Active	Good fit for local angles — net-new Top 5
WYSO	Neenah Ellis <i>Senior Producer</i>	High	Active	Good fit for local angles
El Nuevo Día	Sharon Minelli Pérez <i>Startups & Innovation Reporter</i>	Top 5	Active	Good fit — PR St. Dismas ecosystem angle
El Nuevo Día	Marian Díaz <i>Business Reporter</i>	High	Active	Good fit
El Nuevo Día	Joanisabel González <i>Business & Economy Reporter</i>	Medium	Active	Good fit
cleveland.com	Kaitlin Durbin <i>Reporter</i>	High	Avoid	Cuyahoga County coverage too niche for Joey
cleveland.com	Cory Shaffer <i>Public Impact Reporter</i>	Medium	Avoid	Not suitable
Ideastream	Matthew Richmond <i>Reporter/Producer</i>	High	Avoid	Covers sentencing only — not post-release programs

Angle 1 — Bootstrapping

PUBLICATION	JOURNALIST	PRIORITY	PR STATUS	NOTES
CNBC Make It	Ashton Jackson <i>Make It Success Reporter</i>	High	Pitched Previously	Good match — follow-up lane
CNBC Make It	Tom Huddleston Jr. <i>Senior Entrepreneurs Reporter</i>	Top 5	Active	Suitable — net-new Top 5
Entrepreneur	Amanda Breen <i>Senior Features Writer</i>	High	Pitched Previously	Good match — follow-up lane
Entrepreneur UK	Patricia Cullen <i>Features Writer</i>	Medium	Pitched Previously	Good match — follow-up lane
Fast Company	Ainsley Harris <i>Senior Writer</i>	Low	Pitched Previously	Good match — follow-up lane; departing for Hark
Forbes	Alison Coleman <i>Senior Contributor</i>	Top 5	Pitched Previously	Good match — Top 5 follow-up; bootstrapping beat
Fortune	Indrani Sen <i>Senior Editor Features</i>	Low	Avoid	Mainly covers archives — not suitable for startup pitch
Fortune	Matthew Heimer <i>Executive Editor Features</i>	Low	Avoid	Left Fortune
Grit Daily	Spencer Hulse <i>Editorial Director</i>	Medium	Low	Paid to play — sponsored strategy only; not earned media
Inc.	Graham Winfrey <i>Deputy Digital Editor</i>	High	Pitched Previously	Pitched previously — follow-up; demoted from Top 5 for net-new focus
Inc.	Nick Hawkins <i>Assistant Web Producer</i>	High	Pitched Previously	Pitched previously — follow-up lane
Inc.	Tim Crino <i>Senior Editor</i>	High	Pitched Previously	Pitched previously — follow-up lane
Entrepreneur	Leo Zevin <i>Contributing Writer</i>	Low	Pitched Previously	Pitched previously — athlete entrepreneur beat
Inc.	Christine Lagorio-Chafkin <i>Editor-at-Large</i>	High	Avoid	No longer with Inc.
STAT	Katie Palmer <i>Health Tech Correspondent</i>	Avoid	Avoid	Not suitable — writes critically of GLP-1 space businesses and CEOs
Fierce Healthcare	Heather Landi <i>Executive Editor</i>	Avoid	Avoid	Not suitable — covers big pharma; do not tread on that beat

Angle 2 — The \$8k Comeback

PUBLICATION	JOURNALIST	PRIORITY	PR STATUS	NOTES
Practical Founders Podcast	Greg Head <i>Host</i>	Avoid	Avoid	Software-founder-only podcast — Joey is not a software founder
The Bootstrap	Scotty Allen <i>Host</i>	High	Active	Also hello@theproductbus.com
The Human Challenge	Vanessa Ferlaino <i>Host</i>	High	Avoid	Beat mismatch — refugees DEI female voices; not felony/reentry entrepreneurship
Stigma Podcast	Stephen Hays <i>Host</i>	High	Active	Good match — second-chance healthcare founder
From That Comes This	Rebecca Foster <i>Host</i>	Medium	Low	Good fit but audience too small — Joey time constraint

Angle 3 — The St. Dismas Accelerator

PUBLICATION	JOURNALIST	PRIORITY	PR STATUS	NOTES
WYSO	Will Davis <i>Director Community Voices</i>	Top 5	Active	Good fit for local angles — net-new Top 5
WYSO	Neenah Ellis <i>Senior Producer</i>	High	Active	Good fit for local angles
El Nuevo Día	Sharon Minelli Pérez <i>Startups & Innovation Reporter</i>	Top 5	Active	Good fit — PR St. Dismas ecosystem angle
El Nuevo Día	Marian Díaz <i>Business Reporter</i>	High	Active	Good fit
El Nuevo Día	Joanisabel González <i>Business & Economy Reporter</i>	Medium	Active	Good fit
cleveland.com	Kaitlin Durbin <i>Reporter</i>	High	Avoid	Cuyahoga County coverage too niche for Joey
cleveland.com	Cory Shaffer <i>Public Impact Reporter</i>	Medium	Avoid	Not suitable
Ideastream	Matthew Richmond <i>Reporter/Producer</i>	High	Avoid	Covers sentencing only — not post-release programs

Do not pitch Mary Evans (WYSO) — deceased June 2025. Route to Will Davis / communityvoices@wyso.org. **Global exclusion:** thesurvivalpodcast.com — no contact.

PR manager review (2026-06-23)

Avoid — do not pitch (10)

PUBLICATION	JOURNALIST	PRIORITY	PR STATUS	NOTES
Fortune	Indrani Sen <i>Senior Editor Features</i>	Low	Avoid	Mainly covers archives — not suitable for startup pitch
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Inc.	Christine Lagorio-Chafkin <i>Editor-at-Large</i>	High	Avoid	No longer with Inc.
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cleveland.com	Cory Shaffer <i>Public Impact Reporter</i>	Medium	Avoid	Not suitable
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Low — deprioritize (2)

PUBLICATION	JOURNALIST	PRIORITY	PR STATUS	NOTES
Grit Daily	Spencer Hulse <i>Editorial Director</i>	Medium	Low	Paid to play — sponsored strategy only; not earned media
From That Comes This	Rebecca Foster <i>Host</i>	Medium	Low	Good fit but audience too small — Joey time constraint

Pitched Previously — follow-up (9)

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Entrepreneur	Leo Zevin <i>Contributing Writer</i>	Low	Pitched Previously	Pitched previously — athlete entrepreneur beat

Active — net-new (8)

PUBLICATION	JOURNALIST	PRIORITY	PR STATUS	NOTES
CNBC Make It	Tom Huddleston Jr. <i>Senior Entrepreneurs Reporter</i>	Top 5	Active	Suitable — net-new Top 5

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El Nuevo Día	Joanisabel González <i>Business & Economy Reporter</i>	Medium	Active	Good fit

Research criteria learnings

1. **Verify employment** — confirm journalist still at outlet before Top 5.
2. **Match podcast beat to story** — bootstrap keyword ≠ fit if software-only or DEI-focused.
3. **Healthcare founders** — exclude GLP-1-critical and big-pharma trade reporters.
4. **Local geography** — county reporters ≠ statewide program stories.
5. **Podcast audience floor** — flag sub-scale shows when founder time is limited.
6. **Paid-to-play** — sponsored strategy only (Grit Daily).
7. **Pitched Previously** — follow-up lane; do not consume net-new Top 5 slots.

Media list expansion strategy

1. **Second-chance hiring / workforce DEI** — HR Executive, SHRM, WorkingNation.
2. **Faith-driven business leadership** — Christianity Today Business, Relevant Podcast, Praxis Journal.
3. **DTC telehealth / GLP-1 access** — KFF Health News, Modern Healthcare. Avoid STAT and Fierce Healthcare.

Conversion & friction reduction strategy

1. **Headline-style subject lines** — e.g. EXCLUSIVE: Felony to \$1B – Ohio founder bootstrapped telehealth on \$8K credit card, zero VC
2. **4-bullet pitch block** — Hook · Proof points · Offer · Ask
3. **Link assets, never attach decks** — joeystiver.com

Tweaking Agency

Joey Stiver PR media research · 2026-06-23

Source: [Google Sheet starter list](#)